全民英檢中級 GEPT Intermediate | 第 28 單元 | 思考與知識 · Thinking & Knowledge

The Student Judge at the Science Fair

科展上的學生評審

At the Kang Ming Junior High science fair, Pei-yu was given a job she had not asked for. As the winner of last year's contest, she was invited to join the teachers as a student judge and evaluate twelve projects in the ninth-grade section. 'Look at every aspect,' Mr. Tsai told her, 'not just the posters. A good experiment is one that another person could repeat.'

Most projects were easy to score. Then she reached Table 9, where a boy named Kai-wen had tested whether plants grew faster when music was played to them. His poster was beautiful, and his conclusion was bold: plants that listened to classical music grew exactly twice as tall as the others. Pei-yu was doubtful. In her experience, living things never behaved that neatly. She asked him to demonstrate how he had measured the plants, and he hesitated for a moment before picking up a ruler.

Rather than accuse him, Pei-yu devised a quick test. She asked to see his daily notebook and made a comparison between the raw numbers and the chart on the poster. The notebook told a different story. The music plants were taller, but only by about twenty percent, and on two rainy days they had actually grown less. Kai-wen's face turned red. 'The real numbers looked boring,' he admitted. 'I thought nobody would detect the change.' Apparently, his expectation was that judges only read the posters.

Pei-yu did not report him for cheating. Instead, she noted that the experiment itself was well designed and offered an alternative: present the honest data and explain why a twenty percent difference still mattered. Kai-wen redid his poster that afternoon. He did not win, but Mr. Tsai later told Pei-yu that she had made the fairest decision of the day. 'Judging,' he said, 'means concentrating on what is actually there, not on what you were promised.'

重點單字 Key Vocabulary

單字	詞性	中文	例句

evaluate	*v.*	評估	The teacher will evaluate our projects based on creativity and effort. 老師會根據創意和努力來評估我們的作品。
aspect	*n.*	方面；層面	We discussed every aspect of the plan before voting. 投票前我們討論了計畫的每一個層面。
demonstrate	*v.*	示範；證明	The chef demonstrated how to fold a dumpling in three steps. 廚師示範了如何用三個步驟包水餃。
doubtful	*adj.*	懷疑的；不確定的	I am doubtful that the shop will still be open at midnight. 我懷疑那家店午夜是否還開著。
conclusion	*n.*	結論	After reading both reports, she came to a different conclusion. 讀完兩份報告後，她得出了不同的結論。
devise	*v.*	設計；想出	The students devised a game to help them remember new words. 學生們想出一個遊戲來幫助記憶新單字。
comparison	*n.*	比較	In comparison with last year, the summer was much hotter. 和去年相比，今年夏天熱得多。
detect	*v.*	察覺；偵測	Dogs can detect smells that humans cannot notice. 狗能察覺到人類無法注意到的氣味。
alternative	*n.*	替代方案；另一個選擇	If the MRT is closed, taking a bus is a good alternative. 如果捷運停駛，搭公車是不錯的替代方案。
expectation	*n.*	期望；預期	The movie did not live up to my expectations. 這部電影沒有達到我的期望。

片語 Phrases

twice as + adj. + as	是…的兩倍	This bag is twice as heavy as mine. 這個袋子的重量是我的兩倍。
turn red	臉紅	His face turned red when everyone sang happy birthday to him. 大家為他唱生日快樂歌時，他的臉紅了。
concentrate on	專注於	Turn off the TV so you can concentrate on your homework. 把電視關掉，這樣你才能專心寫作業。

文法與句型 Grammar

Rather than + V / V-ing, S + V

rather than 意思是「而不是」，放在句首時後面接動詞原形或動名詞，表示「沒有做 A，而是做 B」。文中 Rather than accuse him, Pei-yu devised a quick test 表示她沒有指控對方，而是設計了檢驗。

Rather than wait for the elevator, we took the stairs.

我們沒有等電梯，而是走樓梯。

S + V + 倍數 + as + adj. + as + N

倍數（twice、three times 等）加上 as ... as 用來表示「是…的幾倍」，是比較句型的常見變化。文中 grew exactly twice as tall as the others 表示長得剛好是其他植物的兩倍高。

Taipei 101 is three times as tall as our school building.

臺北 101 的高度是我們學校大樓的三倍。

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